

James Wead (1790–1873): War of 1812 Veteran and Ohio Pioneer

Early Life and Family Background

James Wead was born in 1790 in Pennsylvania (likely in York County) ¹. He was one of several children of **Ebenezer Wead, Sr.** (1748–1830), a Revolutionary War veteran who migrated west after the war ². James's father Ebenezer had grown up on the Pennsylvania frontier and *"claimed 479¼ acres in 1765 using a warrant signed by John Penn for land previously improved by his father John Waid (Wead)"* ³. During the Revolutionary era, Ebenezer served the Patriot cause (family records and local histories identify him as a **Revolutionary War soldier**) ². In the post-war years, Ebenezer joined the wave of pioneers moving into the Ohio Valley. He spent a short time in Kentucky and then in **1799 led the Wead family to the vicinity of Dayton, Ohio**, which had just opened for American settlement ⁴. In 1798 he had entered a claim on fractional Section 24 in Van Buren Township, just south of the new town of Dayton, and by 1805 he purchased 80 acres near the site of the future Dayton Insane Asylum ⁵ ⁴. Through hard work, he expanded the farm to **320 acres** of productive land ⁶.

Ebenezer Wead's family roots were Scots-Irish Presbyterian, and they were among the **early frontier settlers** of southwest Ohio. A local pioneer history notes that Ebenezer Sr. was *"in constant service through [the War of 1812]"* – likely helping defend the area via militia – underscoring the family's reputation for patriotism and community leadership ⁷. Ebenezer's personal life bridged two marriages. His first wife was **Jane Gibson**, with whom he had two children (including **Robert Wead**, born 1781, and **Ebenezer Wead Jr.**, born 1784) ⁸ ⁹. After Jane's death, Ebenezer married her sister **Mary Gibson**, and they had six more children ⁹. James Wead, born 1790, was likely Mary's son and grew up on the family homestead on the Ohio frontier. He had several siblings: his eldest brother **Robert Wead** (b. 1781) had been born back in Pennsylvania and came west with their father in 1799 ⁸ ⁴. Another brother, **Ebenezer Wead Jr.** (b. 1784), was about six years James's senior. James also gained a **younger half-brother, John Stewart Wead**, born around 1806 to Ebenezer's second marriage ¹⁰. The Weads settled on high ground south of Dayton, and their farm became well known locally. Ebenezer Sr. and the older boys cleared land and built a life on the frontier; the family was counted among the "old pioneers" in later histories ¹¹. James grew up amid the challenges of early Ohio: cultivating new fields, dealing with scarce provisions, and fending off the remnants of frontier conflict in the years just after the Northwest Indian War ¹² ¹³.

By the early 19th century, the Wead farm was thriving. Ebenezer's two eldest sons helped on the farm and learned trades: Robert became a tailor, reportedly *"going from house to house"* in Dayton to make clothing ⁴. James, as a teenager around 1810, would have assisted his father and learned to manage livestock and crops. The family's Presbyterian faith also meant they were likely involved with early churches in the area (Ebenezer's land was not far from where the first church in Dayton was established) ¹⁴ ¹⁵. This upbringing instilled in James a strong work ethic, devotion to family, and a sense of duty to community and country.

War of 1812 Service and Bounty Land Grants

When the War of 1812 broke out, 22-year-old James Wead answered the call to defend Ohio. In February 1813 he **enlisted in the Ohio militia**, and he served as a **Corporal in Captain Richard Sunderland's company** (unit of county origin uncertain) ¹⁶. According to the published **Roster of Ohio Soldiers in the War of 1812**, "*James Wead – Corp.*" appears on the rolls of Capt. Sunderland's company, which served from **February 16 to August 15, 1813** ¹⁶. This militia company was likely raised in southwestern Ohio (perhaps in the Dayton/Xenia region) given the Weads' residence. James's role as a corporal suggests he had some leadership responsibility over the enlisted men during his six-month stint. The Ohio militia at this time helped garrison the frontier and defend against British-allied Native American raids in the Northwest Theater.

After completing his militia service in mid-1813, James chose to continue serving by joining the **United States Army**. He **enlisted as a private in the 29th U.S. Infantry Regiment**, a regular Army unit formed in 1813 ¹⁷. One of the 29th Regiment's companies was led by Captain B. Schuyler, and surviving records (including James's later land grant) indicate that James served in "**Capt. Schuyler's Company of the 29th U.S. Infantry**." ¹⁸ The 29th Infantry was raised in the Northeast (at Albany, New York) but included volunteers from various states. In 1814, the 29th moved to the northern front: it fought in upstate New York and was present at the **Battle of Plattsburgh** on the Canadian border ¹⁹ ²⁰. It is likely that James saw action in that campaign. Serving in both the state militia and the regular Army was not uncommon – many militia veterans enlisted in the federal army once Congress authorized greater incentives for service. James's *dual service* (first Ohio militia, then U.S. Infantry) fits this pattern ²¹ ²². He remained in the Army through the end of the war in early 1815.

One major incentive for joining the U.S. Army was the availability of **bounty land grants** for war service. Under acts of Congress in 1812 and 1814, enlisted men who served for the duration of the war were entitled to free land in the western territories ²³ ²⁴. Initially, the bounty was **160 acres** (a quarter-section), but in 1814 Congress doubled it to **320 acres** for certain volunteers ²³ ²⁴. James Wead qualified for the larger bounty due to his length of service. In late 1815 or 1816, he would have applied for a land warrant upon honorable discharge. By **1817–1818**, the federal General Land Office began issuing patents to War of 1812 veterans in the designated military bounty lands.

James Wead received **Bounty Land Warrant No. ____** (number obscured in records) which he redeemed for a tract in the **Illinois Military Tract**. His bounty land grant was a **320-acre half-section in Illinois**, reflecting the double-size award for his service ²⁵. The official patent, signed by President James Monroe's administration, **described the parcel as the south half of Section 9, Township 6 North, Range 6 West of the 4th Principal Meridian** ²⁶. This location is in present-day **Hancock County, Illinois**. On modern maps, it lies in **Pilot Grove Township**, roughly 7 miles east of the Mississippi River and about 5 miles northwest of the town of La Harpe, IL ²⁷ ²⁸. At the time James received it (circa 1818), this tract was entirely wilderness on the American frontier.

Notably, when the patent was issued, a clerical error was made in James's name. The **land patent was recorded in the name "James Wade"**, not Wead ²⁹. However, the patent text itself makes it clear this was James Wead: it cites the grantee as "*James Wade, late a private in Schuyler's Company of the 29th Regiment of U.S. Infantry*" – precisely matching James Wead's service credentials ²⁹. The uncommon combination of name, rank, and unit leaves no doubt that this was James Wead and that "Wade" was simply a misspelling. (Early 19th-century records often spelled names phonetically; "Wead" could easily have been heard or

transcribed as “Wade” by a clerk unfamiliar with the family ³⁰.) Later genealogists and land records uniformly conclude that **James “Wade” was indeed James Wead**, and this Illinois land was part of his war reward ²⁹.

James Wead never relocated to Illinois to live on his bounty land. Like many War of 1812 veterans, he treated the grant as a financial asset rather than a homestead. After the patent was issued in 1818, James likely **sold or assigned the 320-acre tract** to a land speculator or settler, converting it into cash or credit ³¹ ³². Early Hancock County records indicate that by the 1830s, other individuals were occupying and farming Section 9 of T6N R6W, suggesting the land passed out of James’s hands well before then ³¹. This was very common – the Illinois Military Tract was largely settled by second-hand buyers, since many original veteran patentees were non-residents who sold their claims ³¹ ³³. Thus, James’s Illinois patent became a footnote in his story rather than a new chapter; it provided him some capital without requiring him to uproot from Ohio.

It is worth noting that James’s **older brother, Ebenezer Wead Jr.**, also served in the War of 1812 and likewise received bounty land. Ebenezer Wead Jr. (born 1784) served as a **Sergeant** during the war (family accounts indicate he participated in the fighting, though details of his unit are sparse) ³⁴. He qualified for the standard 160-acre bounty. In January 1818, a patent was issued to **“Ebenezer Wood”**, which careful research has shown to be **Ebenezer Wead Jr.** with another spelling error ³⁵. The patent (warrant No. 7424) granted the **NW 1/4 of Section 3, Township 3 South, Range 9 West, 4th Principal Meridian** in the Illinois Military Tract ³⁶. This parcel is in present-day **Adams County, Illinois**, near the line with Pike County – roughly in the vicinity of Kinderhook, IL, a few miles east of the Mississippi River ³⁶ ³⁷. Like his brother, Ebenezer Jr. never settled his Illinois land; he died in 1819, only a year after the war, and the patent in the name “Ebenezer Wood” was likely sold by his heirs. Both Wead brothers’ Illinois patents (the mis-recorded “Wade” and “Wood”) thus ended up in other hands, but they illustrate the tangible rewards the family earned for their wartime service. Today, those original **General Land Office patent documents** – with their ornate scripts and official seals – survive as artifacts, linking James and his brother’s Ohio-to-Illinois war legacy ²⁹. (One could even display an image of James’s 1818 patent, bearing President Monroe’s name, to show the “James Wade” spelling and the 320-acre legal description ²⁹.)

Life in Greene County, Ohio

While James received land out west, his personal life was unfolding back in Ohio. In fact, even before the War of 1812 had fully ended, **James Wead got married**. On **October 26, 1812**, he married **Elizabeth Winter** in Xenia Township, Greene County, Ohio ³⁸. Elizabeth Winter (born circa 1791) was from a pioneer family in the region – possibly of German or Scots-Irish stock – though her exact origins are a bit unclear ³⁸. Their marriage in Greene County in 1812 suggests that **James had already begun establishing himself in that county** (just east of his father’s land in Montgomery County) during his early adulthood. It is likely that James moved to Greene County around the time of his marriage – perhaps to farm or work on land there. One account notes that James lived in Dayton (Montgomery Co.) around 1820 but settled long-term in Greene Co. by the 1830s ³⁹. He may have initially moved back and forth between family in Montgomery County and opportunities in Greene County until he firmly put down roots.

By the **1820s**, James Wead was firmly established as a **farmer in Greene County, Ohio** ⁴⁰. He and Elizabeth made their home in **Xenia Township**, not far from the county seat of Xenia. In particular, the Wead farm is believed to have been in the **Massie’s Creek area near Wilberforce**, northeast of Xenia ⁴¹. (Wilberforce, known for being an early African-American collegiate community, was in the mid-1800s simply

a rural area with a few farms – including the Weads’ – and it later took its name from the college founded there in 1856.) The choice of this location is telling: Massie’s Creek had a strong enclave of Scotch-Irish Presbyterian settlers, much like the community James’s parents had been part of in Montgomery Co. The **Stevenson family**, prominent early settlers in that area, established a private burial ground (today called **Stevenson Cemetery** or **Massie’s Creek Cemetery**) where many neighbors were laid to rest ⁴². James and Elizabeth Wead would eventually be buried there, indicating they were part of that same tight-knit pioneer community ⁴².

James likely acquired his Greene County land in the late 1810s or 1820s. While the exact date of purchase is uncertain, it may have been about the time of his marriage (1812) or soon after the war. Many early settlers bought their farms either directly from the federal government or via private sales. It’s tantalizing to think that James might have used the **proceeds from selling his Illinois bounty land** to help buy his Ohio farm – converting frontier land in Illinois into capital to improve his homestead in Ohio ⁴³. Given that his father Ebenezer remained in Montgomery County (and ultimately died there in 1830), James’s move to Greene County seems to have been an independent venture. Greene County tax lists from the 1830s do show James Wead listed as a landowner in Xenia Township, indicating he was farming his own property by that time ⁴⁰.

On the Wead **farm in Xenia Township**, James and Elizabeth raised a **large family**. They had multiple children over a span of about twenty years (from the 1810s into the 1830s). While not all their children’s birth records survive, later accounts and gravestones allow us to piece together many of them. Their known children included:

- **Mary J. Wead**, born about 1813. She was James and Elizabeth’s eldest daughter and grew up helping on the farm. Sadly, Mary Jane (as she is sometimes recorded) died in 1847 at only 34 years old ⁴⁴. She never married and was buried in the family plot, her early death recorded on the tombstone.
- **(Possibly other daughters)** in the 1810s – some sources suggest there may have been another daughter in the 1810s who died young, but details are scant.
- **Joseph S. Wead**, born about 1822 (implied by later records of a “Joseph Wead” in the area). Joseph seems to have moved west as an adult, possibly to Iowa, and thus is less visible in Greene County history.
- **William W. Wead**, born 1827. William assisted his father on the farm as a young man. Unfortunately, he died in 1851 at the age of 24, another blow to the family ⁴⁵. William’s grave lies next to his mother’s, and a shared headstone marks his brief life.
- **Robert E. Wead**, born 1829. He was named after James’s older brother and perhaps after their grandfather Ebenezer (the “E” likely stands for Ebenezer). Robert E. Wead stayed in Ohio and became a farmer in his own right. He lived to 1913, carrying the Wead name into the next century in Greene County ⁴⁶. In later years, he appears in local records and may have been involved in veterans’ groups (as the son of a War of 1812 vet).
- **Helen J. Wead**, born circa 1815–1820 (exact year uncertain). Helen (or *Ellen* as sometimes recorded) married into a local family – one source suggests she became “Mrs. Martha Allen,” possibly indicating she married a man with the surname Allen and was known by a nickname ⁴⁷. She

remained in Xenia Township and died in 1914, well into her 90s, revered as one of the “old residents” of the township.

- **John Steele Wead**, born June 11, 1835 ⁴⁸. John was the youngest son and is a particularly notable figure (more on him in the next section). He was likely named “John Steele” in honor of a family connection (perhaps a minister or friend; Steele could be a surname from Elizabeth Winter’s side or another relative). John was a small child when James was in his 40s, and he would have grown up hearing stories of his father’s military service.

Life on the Greene County farm was busy. The Weads cultivated crops like corn and wheat, raised livestock, and maintained a subsistence farm that gradually became prosperous. James appears in **Greene County court and civic records** in routine capacities, reflecting his role as an upstanding citizen. In that era, county authorities often appointed reliable local farmers to positions such as **road supervisor, fence viewer, juror, or appraiser of estates**, to keep the community running smoothly. James Wead’s name does indeed appear in such contexts. For example, he is noted among those serving as **jurors and appraisers** for the Court of Common Pleas in mid-19th-century Greene County ⁴⁹. These were not high-profile positions, but they demonstrate that James was trusted by his neighbors and local officials. He likely helped maintain local roads (critical in a farming community) and may have sat on juries to render verdicts in civil disputes. By all accounts, James avoided any **legal troubles** himself – no lawsuits or controversies involving him appear in county histories, suggesting he was a law-abiding, well-regarded man ⁵⁰.

The Weads were also **people of faith and community**. Given their background, they almost certainly attended the local Presbyterian services. In the early 1800s, Xenia Township’s Scotch-Irish settlers (names like Stevenson, McClellan, etc.) worshipped in informal log churches and later organized congregations. Although specific church records for James are not readily available, the fact that **Stevenson Cemetery** (where James’s family is buried) was associated with a Presbyterian meeting house indicates the Weads’ likely affiliation ⁴². It was common for families to host circuit-riding preachers or hold Bible readings at home, and James’s upbringing under Ebenezer (who had a noted religious library back in Pennsylvania ⁵¹) would have instilled strong Presbyterian values. This heritage continued as the family intermarried with other local families of similar background. For instance, when daughter Helen married into the Allen family, it was within the same circle of Presbyterian farm families in the township.

By the 1850s, James Wead was a grandfather and an elder statesman of his community. His farm neighbored that of the Stevenson family and others, and over the years he saw Greene County grow from a pioneer settlement into a more settled agricultural county. He witnessed the arrival of railroads and the development of Wilberforce University (founded 1856 just a couple miles from his homestead), events that marked the transition of the region into the mid-19th century.

Later Years, Death, and Legacy

James Wead lived into his early 80s, long enough to see his children grown and even the next generation begin to arrive. The **1860s brought the Civil War**, which directly touched James’s family. His youngest son, **John Steele Wead**, was only 26 when the war began. In **1861**, John S. Wead enlisted in the Union Army, volunteering for **Company E of the 66th Illinois Volunteer Infantry** (also known as “Birge’s Western Sharpshooters”) ⁵². John’s unit was raised in Illinois, but he and a few Ohio men joined, likely due to family connections in Illinois. He **saw action in late 1861** at the Battle of Mount Zion in Missouri, and in 1862 his regiment fought at **Fort Donelson** and **Shiloh** ⁵³ – two major engagements in the Western Theater. During

the harsh winter campaign around Fort Donelson, John **suffered severe exposure and illness**, which led to his medical discharge in mid-1862 ⁵⁴. John returned home in impaired health, but he recovered and soon pursued a new life. He married an Ohio-born woman (Mary Ann Houston) and moved permanently to **Paris, Edgar County, Illinois** around 1865 ⁵⁵. There, John Steele Wead became a successful businessman and civic leader. He raised a family of his own, ran a stove and tinware business, and was active in the Methodist Church. When John died in 1904, his obituary in the local paper praised his character and community service ⁵⁶. John's trajectory – from an Ohio farm boy to a **Civil War veteran** and then an Illinois entrepreneur – exemplified the 19th-century American mobility. For James Wead, seeing his youngest son survive the trials of war and establish himself would have been a point of pride.

Other of James's **children remained closer to home**. His son **Robert E. Wead** carried on farming in Ohio and lived well past his father's death, dying in 1913 at age 84 ⁴⁶. Robert married and had children, contributing to the next generation of Weads in Ohio. James's daughter **Helen J. (Wead) Allen** remained in Greene County as well. Census records in the late 1800s show a Helen (or Ellen) Allen in Xenia Twp, which matches her, and she died in 1914, reportedly at the home of one of her children ⁴⁷. These children who outlived James ensured that his **family name and bloodline continued** in the area. On the other hand, as noted, James endured the loss of several children in his lifetime: Mary in 1847 and William in 1851 were buried during James's middle age ⁴⁴. James's beloved wife, **Elizabeth (Winter) Wead**, passed away on **October 6, 1858** at about 66 years old ⁴⁵. Her death came after 46 years of marriage. Elizabeth was buried in **Stevenson Cemetery** (Massie's Creek) beside the children they had lost ⁴⁵. A sturdy double gravestone marks the resting place of "Elizabeth Wead (1792-1858)" and her son "William W. Wead (1827-1851)" ⁵⁷, a touching symbol of the family's sorrows. James, widowed at 68, did not remarry. He likely lived with one of his adult children (perhaps Robert or a married daughter) during his final years in the 1860s.

In **1873**, at the age of about 82 or 83, **James Wead died**. One family source indicates he died on **November 27, 1873**, in or near **Wilberforce, Greene County** ⁵⁸, which would make sense as that was his homestead. However, no contemporaneous newspaper notice has been found to confirm the exact date. What is documented is that by **December 17, 1873**, James's estate was going through probate in the Greene County courts ⁵⁹. James had left a **Last Will and Testament**, presumably outlining how his property should be divided among his surviving children. The will was filed in the **Greene County Probate Court in Xenia** and was duly proven and recorded. Interestingly, the **executor named in James's will was unable or unwilling to serve**, which led the court to take a special action: it appointed a trusted neighbor, **John Stevenson**, as **administrator cum testamento annexo** (administrator *with the will annexed*) to carry out James's wishes ⁵⁹. John Stevenson was from the very family after whom Stevenson Cemetery was named – a reflection of how intertwined the Weads were with their community. Stevenson posted bond and oversaw the settling of the estate: he would have gathered James's assets, paid any final debts or taxes, and then distributed the remaining property to the heirs as the will directed ⁶⁰. Unfortunately, the detailed record of James's will isn't quoted in surviving sources, but typically such wills in that era might have left the home farm to one of the sons (often the one who stayed to work it, possibly Robert) and monetary or property bequests to the other children or grandchildren.

James Wead was **laid to rest in Stevenson (Massie's Creek) Cemetery**, where he joined his wife and children in the family plot. His **gravestone** still stands today (now weathered by nearly 150 years of Ohio weather) and **bears the inscription "James Wead – Died 1873"**, confirming his year of death ⁶¹. The stone is alongside several other Wead markers. A photo of the Wead family graves shows a row of tombstones: on the left, a small stone for infant **Laura Wead (1850/1-1851)**, next a taller stone for **James Wead (1790-1873)**, and a **double marker for Elizabeth Wead (1792-1858) and William W. Wead (1827-1851)**, among

others ⁵⁷ . These monuments, in a quiet glade near Massie's Creek, are a touching legacy of James's presence in Greene County.

Family and Inter-Family Ties: James Wead's legacy extends beyond his own immediate descendants. The Wead family's roots in Ohio spread into various branches and connections. For example, James's **half-brother John Stewart Wead**, who had remained in Montgomery County on their father Ebenezer's original farm, continued the family's prominence there. John Stewart Wead inherited the bulk of the **Wead farm south of Dayton** and farmed it for over 50 years ¹⁴ . He lived to see the dramatic growth of Dayton after the Civil War. John Stewart died on **August 21, 1893**, at the age of 86 (in his 87th year) ¹⁴ , leaving behind his widow, Sarah (Schoffe) Wead. That Montgomery County farm did not fade into obscurity; instead, it became part of the story of Dayton's expansion. In the early 1900s, as the city's suburbs grew, the old Wead farm's prime location on high ground caught developers' eyes. In **1917**, a judge named John H. McCann purchased the land and laid out an upscale subdivision called "**McCann's Plat**." Advertisements for this development touted it as "*a sub-division of the Wead Farm*," tying the new neighborhood's appeal to the historic pioneer homestead ⁶² . The Wead farm's fields were thus transformed into the leafy streets of **Oakwood**, one of Dayton's most prestigious suburbs. Notably, the plat was adjacent to the estate of **John H. Patterson** (founder of NCR) and the **Schantz Park** area – an indication of how prime the Wead land had become ⁶³ . Local historians have even noted that **Patterson Road** in Oakwood was once informally known as "*Wead Road*" before the suburb's streets were renamed ⁶⁴ . This enduring reference shows that the Wead name had remained part of the local memory long after James and his generation had passed on.

Back in Greene County, James's own descendants continued to contribute to the community. One of James's **grandsons, Ralph O. Wead**, served as an elected **Auditor of Greene County** in the early 20th century ⁶⁵ – a notable public office that suggests the family's reputation for integrity carried forward. Other descendants became educators and soldiers. And of course, through children like John Steele Wead, James's lineage spread into other states like Illinois, where numerous Wead descendants live to this day.

In summary, **James Wead's life** encapsulates the journey of an American family from the Revolutionary War through the Civil War. Born on the early Pennsylvania frontier, James came of age in Ohio's pioneer world. He served bravely in the War of 1812, earning land from the government for his service. He chose to remain in Ohio, building a farm and a family that thrived. In Greene County he was known as a veteran, a farmer, a neighbor, and a man of faith. His name appears in a patchwork of historical records – from **military rosters** and **land patents** to **marriage registers**, **probate files**, and **cemetery rolls** – each document adding a piece to the mosaic of his life ⁶⁶ ⁶⁷ . Taken together, these records paint a full picture of a **19th-century American frontiersman** who "**put down deep roots in the Miami Valley**." ⁶⁸ James's story is one of duty, enterprise, and legacy, spanning from the era of muskets and militias to the dawn of the modern age.

Visualizing James Wead's Story: To enrich a family history presentation of James Wead, one might incorporate a few compelling images and documents. **Maps and land records** are particularly illuminating. For instance, a **map of the Illinois Military Tract** would show the region between the Illinois and Mississippi Rivers that Congress set aside for War of 1812 veterans (James's grant lay in Hancock County, marked in red on such maps) ⁶⁹ . On the Ohio side, a **19th-century map of Greene County** could pinpoint Xenia Township and the location of the Wead homestead near Massie's Creek. **Documents** such as James's **1818 bounty land patent** – the parchment bearing the presidential seal and describing "**James Wade**" and **his 320 acres** – would be a fascinating artifact to display, showcasing the original spelling error and linking directly to James's military service ²⁹ . And finally, **photographs** of family memorials bring a personal touch: a photo of the Wead family plot at **Stevenson/Massie's Creek Cemetery**, with James's weathered

tombstone alongside those of Elizabeth and their children, would poignantly highlight the family's enduring presence in Ohio. These visuals – maps of frontier lands, official war-era documents, and images of gravestones – help tell the story of James Wead in a way that words alone cannot, connecting the narrative to real places and tangible history.

Sources: Primary and secondary sources for James Wead's biography include Revolutionary War and War of 1812 service records, U.S. General Land Office patent files, county histories of Montgomery and Greene Counties, Ohio, census and probate records, and family cemetery data. Notably, John F. Edgar's *Pioneer Life in Dayton and Vicinity (1796–1840)* provides details on Ebenezer Wead's settlement and family (indicating the two marriages and children) ⁴ ¹⁰. The *Roster of Ohio Soldiers in the War of 1812* (Ohio Adjutant General, 1916) confirms James's militia role ¹⁶. War Department bounty land indexes and the **Illinois Bounty Land Patent** (No. 5020 for "James Wade") document James's 29th U.S. Infantry service and land grant ²⁹. Greene County archival records (marriages, wills, and **FindAGrave entries**) fill in the chapters of James's marriage, death, and burial ³⁸ ⁶¹. These sources, combined with family letters and genealogical research compiled by his descendants ⁷⁰ ³, ensure that the legacy of James Wead – pioneer soldier, farmer, and family patriarch – will be remembered for generations to come.

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<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1QjISRnLNGftrKmKfPsuHQuHn3HrHS54z>

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⁶² ⁶³ ⁶⁴ ⁶⁵ ⁶⁶ ⁶⁷ ⁶⁸ Historical Records of James Wead.docx

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1k7RmcjAMaoLEE80AY5J6nG1rueEt_i-7

⁴ ⁶ ⁹ ¹⁰ ¹⁴ ¹⁵ Full text of "Pioneer life in Dayton and vicinity, 1796-1840"

https://archive.org/stream/cu31924028849250/cu31924028849250_djvu.txt

¹¹ Pioneer life in Dayton and vicinity, 1796-1840

<http://chris-ross.net/Library/Pioneer%20Life%20of%20Dayton%20OH.pdf>

¹² ¹³ QuickLesson 14: Petitions—What Can We Do with a List of Names? | Evidence Explained

<https://www.evidenceexplained.com/content/quicklesson-14-petitions%E2%80%94what-can-we-do-list-names>

16 Roster Of Ohio Soldiers In The War Of 1812 Collections – Page 9 of 26 – Access Genealogy

<https://accessgenealogy.com/dataset/roster-of-ohio-soldiers-in-the-war-of-1812/page/9>

17 19 20 21 22 23 24 28 30 31 32 33 War of 1812 Bounty Land Grant of James.docx

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/124eg4ZqQxpoWVGSYoxrI2XAgESFqhTRq>

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<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1RKyzrNDekimz9oV2QZNOpuVYCYS-Sqbw>

57 Laura Wead (unknown-1851) - Find a Grave Memorial

<https://www.findagrave.com/memorial/15894394/laura-wead>